links intact. However, its ability to effectively threaten any one of its partners with favouring the others does not amount to completely ignoring international influence.

We have some evidence that it set up the inquiry into the violence in Rakhine in order to ensure that President Obama's visit went ahead. A recent US State Department report on ethnic Rakhine involvement in organising the exodus of Rohingya refugees has led to the arrest and trial of a few low-level smugglers.[12] Equally, although the regime attempted to defy its ASEAN partners over the May–June 2015 refugee crisis, in the end it took steps to meet their demands.[13]

Thus there is scope for international leverage on Myanmar. The state needs foreign investment and even though its first instinct will often be to reject any such pressure as foreign intervention in domestic affairs, it will eventually respond to it. International opinion is critical,[14] should we be willing, but it is important to choose the right issues. Each of the genocides considered in Chapter 5 happened when either the few states with leverage simply did not care (Turkey in 1915, the USSR in 1941–3), the state had become so isolated that such pressure no longer had any effect (Nazi Germany after 1942), or the wider international community did not want to face up to its responsibilities (Rwanda). We must not repeat the mistakes of the past.

My suggestion is that the wider world needs to focus on two key issues. The first is to ensure that the Rohingyas regain proper citizenship. This simple step is going to be fundamental to proving to the world that the Myanmar regime is no longer complicit in planning genocide.[15] Secondly, external powers must stop treating the persecution of the Rohingyas as a secondary concern. Unless Myanmar's rulers change policy, there is a serious risk of destabilising the entire region as well as of outright genocide. As has been repeated throughout this book, the potential influence of external powers is critical in defusing the current situation. It is, in the short-term, unlikely that any foreign state or international body will force Myanmar to grant citizenship to the Rohingyas, but pressure must be maintained.

An interview with a senior Rohingya politician (barred from standing in the 2015 elections) speaking under conditions of anonymity, indicated that some in Myanmar are clear as to both importance of international pressure and its limits: